FJ 10310/51 — F 110

United Kingdom Liaison Mission in Japan,

TOKYO.

SECRET
(1030/59/52)

11th February, 1952.

Dear R.A.,

As you no doubt realise, we have rather less than 24 hours in which to reply to letters coming by the confidential bag if we are to catch the outgoing bag. I have therefore not had time to go exhaustively into the question raised in your letter FJ 10310/44 of 4th February, in which you enclosed a further copy of the Dulles Memorandum and a record of the conversation between the Secretary of State and Mr. Acheson on 10th January. My impression is, however, that we have pretty well said all there is to say on the subject.

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As we indicated in our despatch No. 15 of 28th January, the full degree of Japanese reaction to the Yoshida letter may not become apparent until after the Treaty comes into force. Both Yoshida's friends and his enemies are probably agreed that the Treaty is the main thing. Some people here think that the Japanese may, after the Treaty is in force, double-cross the Americans, but though that might be poetic justice it can hardly improve the situation. It would, of course, be easy for the Japanese so to conduct themselves in their negotiations with Chiang Kai-shek as to preclude any agreement being reached. But this would have a very bad effect on Japan's relations with the United States, and that will not do any good to anyone.

I have only seen Yoshida once since 14th December and that was when he came to offer his condolences on the King's death on 7th February. It was hardly an occasion when one could bring up other subjects, though Yoshida himself did bring up the question of depositing sterling in London as a gesture to bondholders. At the present stage it is difficult for me to seek interviews with the Prime Minister or at the Foreign Office without attracting widespread attention, and until I am authorised to discuss the establishment of diplomatic relations I have no particular excuse to seek such interviews.

You ask what I think our future rôle should be. For the moment, I do not think there is anything we can do. The Japanese know our point of view perfectly well, but as they are engaged in toeing the line with the Americans

(as/

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Foreign Office.

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(as to which they consider they have no choice) they do not seek our company while they are engaged in this distasteful task. On the whole, therefore, I think silence is the best policy for the present. I have sent the Prime Minister extracts from Hansard of 30th January and 5th February, so that he shall be in no doubt about the Secretary of State's views, but in fact I do not think that he is in any doubt, or in any disagreement with them. But you would not get him to say so.

Yours ever,

Bill Nunn

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